

More searches

According to ComScore, both Google and Bing upped their market share recently while Yahoo! lost a little

Google Deals

Google is supposedly in talks to buy out deal-of-the-day website Groupon

Icons of Trust

- pared to the result of last years survey.
2. Over the top recall of Seagate is excellent. Nearly four times more people will mention Seagate over WD when asked for naming a hard drive brand.
 3. When it comes to credibility and trust, people trust Seagate more. Western Digital trails by a good 13 per cent in both parameters. Transcend is a distant third, although note that they are external drive vendors and do not make internal hard drives.
 4. Seagate and WD are associated with being the most technologically advanced, with Seagate having a four per cent lead. Their nearest competitor, Hitachi, is light years away.
 5. Seagate and WD are also easy to use. Obviously, the more people that adopt a brand, the more use it, and the drives away unnecessary opinions. After all, who heard of a hard drive being hard to use? Unsurprisingly, A-Data is at the bottom of this list. They're a new brand in India, and not many people will have heard of them. In fact, they weren't even on our radar last year.
 6. Our readers also felt that Seagate was the easiest brand to get information on, and counter sales people were more informed, and could better impart knowledge about it. WD was second here, and Transcend comes in third.
 7. Seagate is also perceived to be cheaper to own. A little less than double the votes went to Seagate over WD for this parameter. Obviously, the trust Seagate has built over the years is still their forte.
 8. Seagate's credibility score goes through the roof with WD following closely behind. Both brands have gained a point each over last year, and there's a difference of five per cent between both.

The most trusted

Seagate is the most trusted, followed by WD. Transcend gets third position.

Printers/MFDs

Not the most interesting of categories to consumers, but this is an important market for imaging professionals and

corporates.

Aside from the biggest players HP, Canon and Epson, there are also a lot of other brands like Samsung, Xerox, Brother and Wipro that do a lot of business in India. Since most of the business of printers and MFDs is B2B, we consumers see a very small trickle over of products in the market. However, we were interested in our readers' opinions on these peripherals.

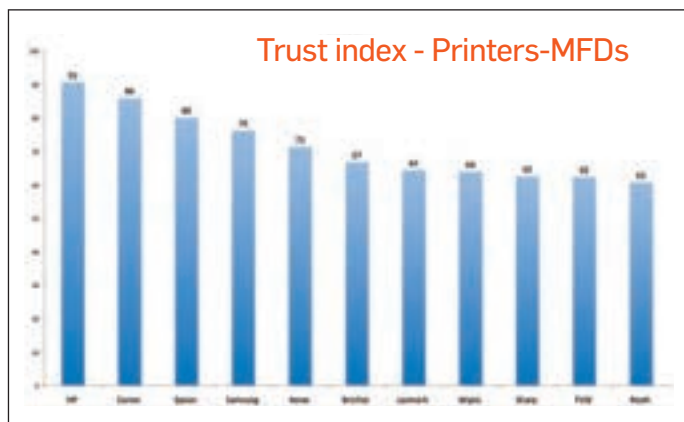
Market watch

Nothing radically new in terms of technology has happened over the past year. That being said, we see laser printers gradually pervading, what was, formerly inkjet- only usage scenarios. Due to the lower cost per page and higher duty cycles of laser devices, more and more manufacturers are offering affordable options with lower feature sets. Another trend we've seen continue is the increasing acceptance of MFDs. Due to the sheer convenience of having more than one function in a single device, MFDs have been very popular. This saves not only on space and time, but also on cost, and some inkjet MFDs finally make cost sense to a lot of households.

Perceptions from our survey

1. A phenomenal chunk of our readers own HP printers or MFDs, nearly 4.5 times more than the second most owned brand i.e. Canon. No surprise that people feel HP is the most cost effective solution. People also feel HP is the most trustworthy brand. While we don't intend to undermine the validity of the scores, it bears mention that with such a high percentage of people owning an HP device, it's natural that the scores would be slightly skewed in their favour. Of course, the corollary to this is that people must have had a valid reason

Trust index - Printers-MFDs



- for purchasing HP in the first place.
2. Interestingly, a good 20 per cent more people believe that HP devices don't breakdown as easily as other brands. Canon is voted as the next most rugged brand. A similar number of people also believe that HP is more innovative with their printing solutions.
 3. Compared to last year, Canon seems to have gained some ground on HP when it comes to credibility. Epson has also gained ground, but at a slightly slower rate.
 4. Users are more satisfied with the top three brands this year, compared to last year. This is heartening, though we see little change in the other brands. Sharp and Samsung have been the biggest gainers, gaining 7 and 4 per cent respectively in terms of overall consumer satisfaction.
 5. HP was also voted as the most responsive to customers needs, followed in equidistant margins by Canon and Epson.
 6. It seems sales people at counters need to pass on more knowledge to consumers. Even though HP was the top dog in this arena, overall, lots of work is to be done here, and we feel all brands need to pull up their socks when it comes to education of their over-the-counter sales teams.

The most trusted

HP was voted the most trusted brand this year, maintaining a distance between its nearest rival Canon. Epson stood in third place – pretty much unchanged from last year. 